

GAMBIT PLAY

UX Writing Portfolio — Sports Betting Platform · Spec Work Case Study

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This document is a speculative UX writing case study created to demonstrate brand voice definition, microcopy, and multilingual content management skills within the sports betting sector. "Gambit Play" is a fictional, original brand concept created solely for portfolio purposes.

ABOUT THIS PROJECT

Brand: Gambit Play — a fictional premium sports betting platform for players who treat betting as a game of strategy and skill, not luck.

Challenge: Define a sleek, sophisticated brand voice and write copy across five core user touchpoints — from the first impression on the homepage to in-app notifications — ensuring clarity, trust, and engagement at every stage of the customer journey.

Approach: Each section opens with the brand voice principle being applied, followed by the copy, a before/after rewrite comparison, and a writer's note explaining the reasoning behind the words.

Homepage Copy Registration Flow Bonus & Promotions Deposit & Withdrawal UI Push Notifications

BRAND VOICE DEFINITION — GAMBIT PLAY

Before writing a single word of copy, I defined the brand's voice. Every piece of copy in this portfolio flows from these principles.

Brand Personality

Gambit Play is the sharp strategist in the room — the one who studies the form, reads the odds, and makes the calculated move while everyone else is guessing. It speaks with quiet confidence, never hype. It respects the user's intelligence and treats betting as a game of skill, not chaos.

Voice Dimensions

Dimension	We Are	We Are Not
Strategic	Sharp, deliberate, informed	Reckless, chaotic, or impulsive
Premium	Polished, understated, confident	Flashy, loud, or gimmicky
Trustworthy	Transparent, precise, compliant	Vague, evasive, or hiding behind jargon
Respectful	Treats users as intelligent adults	Patronising, pushy, or guilt-tripping

Writing Rules

- ▶ Use second person (“you”, “your”) to keep copy personal and direct.
- ▶ Lead with insight, not hype. Replace exclamation points with confidence — let the offer speak for itself.
- ▶ CTAs are short, verb-first, and specific (“Place Your Bet” not “Click Here”).
- ▶ Avoid gambling clichés (“luck”, “jackpot energy”, “win big!”). Favour language of strategy, form, and odds.
- ▶ Responsible gambling language is always clear, calm, and framed as smart play — never hidden, never negative.

01 · HOMEPAGE HERO COPY & TAGLINE

Touchpoint: Homepage — the first impression. The copy must establish the brand's premium, strategic identity and move the user towards registration without ever feeling like a hard sell.

First Impression Brand Voice CTA Optimisation Trust Signals

Hero Headline

PRIMARY HEADLINE

Every Match Has a Move. Make Yours.

✍ **Writer's note:** Frames betting as strategy, not chance — core to the brand's premium positioning. The two-sentence structure (statement, then command) creates rhythm without needing an exclamation point.

Subheadline

SUPPORTING COPY

Live odds, sharp markets, and instant payouts — built for players who study the game before they play it.

✍ **Writer's note:** “Study the game before they play it” speaks directly to the strategist persona, filtering for the audience who'll resonate most with a premium positioning.

Primary CTA

BUTTON COPY

Explore Today's Markets

✍ **Writer's note:** “Explore” is lower-pressure than “Bet Now”, fitting a brand that wants to feel considered rather than impulsive — while still being a clear, specific action.

Trust Bar (below hero)

MICROCOPY — 3 TRUST SIGNALS

Licensed & Regulated | Payouts in Minutes | Markets Updated in Real Time

✍ **Writer's note:** No emoji here, unlike a more casual brand — the premium tone calls for clean, typographic trust signals instead.

Before / After Rewrite

Original generic copy seen across many sports betting platforms:

BEFORE

Welcome to Gambit Play! Bet on your favourite sports and win big! Sign up now to get started!

AFTER

Every Match Has a Move. Make Yours. Live odds, sharp markets, and instant payouts — built for players who study the game before they play it. Explore Today's Markets

02 · REGISTRATION & ONBOARDING FLOW MICROCOPY

Touchpoint: Registration — the highest drop-off point in any betting funnel. Every word must reduce friction, build confidence, and keep the user moving forward.

Step 1 of 3 — Account Details

SCREEN HEADER

Set up your account — two minutes, then you're in.

✍ **Writer's note:** Setting a time expectation reduces abandonment. The clipped, confident sentence structure matches the brand's restrained tone.

EMAIL FIELD HELPER TEXT

Your login link goes here. Nothing else — no spam.

PASSWORD FIELD HELPER TEXT

8+ characters. Mix it up with numbers and symbols for a stronger account.

INLINE ERROR — INVALID EMAIL

That email doesn't look complete. Try the format name@example.com.

INLINE ERROR — PASSWORD TOO SHORT

Just a touch more — 8 characters minimum.

✍ **Writer's note:** Even error states stay composed and brief, never alarmist — consistent with the strategist persona who doesn't panic.

Step 2 of 3 — Personal Details

SCREEN HEADER

A few details to keep your account secure.

DATE OF BIRTH HELPER TEXT

You must be 18 or older to play. This confirms your eligibility.

COUNTRY DROPDOWN HELPER TEXT

This determines which markets and odds formats you'll see.

Step 3 of 3 — Confirm & Go

SCREEN HEADER

Last step. Confirm the details below and you're in.

TERMS CHECKBOX

I'm 18+, I've read the Terms & Conditions, and I'll play within my limits.

✍ **Writer's note:** “Play within my limits” replaces typical “play responsibly” language with phrasing that fits the strategic, self-controlled brand persona.

SUBMIT CTA

Create My Account

SUCCESS STATE

You're in, [Name]. Your account is ready — today's markets are live now.

✍ **Writer's note:** No emoji, no exclamation mark — the success moment is handled with the same composed confidence as the rest of the brand.

Before / After Rewrite

BEFORE

Error: The email address you have entered is not valid. Please re-enter a valid email address in the field provided.

AFTER

That email doesn't look complete. Try the format name@example.com.

03 • BONUS & PROMOTIONS COPY

Touchpoint: Promotions page and in-app banners. Bonus copy must feel like a smart opportunity, not a sales push — clarity on terms is non-negotiable in a regulated industry.

Promotional Copy Restrained Urgency Compliance Language CTA Optimisation

Welcome Bonus Banner

HEADLINE

Matched Stake on Your First Bet — Up to ₦50,000

✍ **Writer's note:** “Matched Stake” uses precise betting terminology rather than generic “bonus” language, reinforcing the premium, knowledgeable tone.

SUBHEADLINE

Back your first pick with confidence. We'll match your stake, win or lose.

CTA

View Offer Details

✍ **Writer's note:** A more measured CTA than “Claim Now” — consistent with a brand that doesn't need urgency tactics to be compelling.

TERMS LINE (COMPLIANCE)

18+ | New customers only | Min. stake ₦1,000 | Max. refund ₦50,000 | Full T&Cs apply

✍ **Writer's note:** Full terms are shown plainly, never minimised — for a brand built on trust and precision, hiding terms would directly contradict the voice.

Loyalty Tier — In-App Card

CARD HEADLINE

You're approaching Strategist Tier

✍ **Writer's note:** Naming the top loyalty tier “Strategist” reinforces brand identity at every touchpoint, not just in marketing copy.

CARD BODY

Strategist Tier unlocks priority payouts, sharper odds boosts, and a dedicated account manager.

CTA

View My Progress

Time-Bound Offer Banner

HEADLINE

Odds Boost: This Weekend's Fixtures Only

COUNTDOWN MICROCOPY

Boosted odds lock in Sunday at kickoff.

✍ **Writer's note:** “At kickoff” is a sports-specific deadline rather than a generic countdown — it feels native to the audience rather than a borrowed e-commerce tactic.

Before / After Rewrite

BEFORE

Congratulations! You are eligible for our welcome bonus offer. Click below to activate your bonus now! T&Cs apply.

AFTER

*Matched Stake on Your First Bet — Up to ₦50,000
Back your first pick with confidence. We'll match your stake, win or lose. View Offer Details*

04 • DEPOSIT & WITHDRAWAL UI COPY

Touchpoint: Payment flows — the most trust-critical moment in the user journey. Copy must feel secure, precise, and frictionless.

UI Microcopy Trust Signals Error Handling Empty States

Deposit Flow

PAGE HEADING

Fund Your Account

 **Writer's note:** Plain and direct — the premium brand doesn't need to oversell a basic functional step.

AMOUNT FIELD HELPER TEXT

Min. ₦500 · Max. ₦10,000,000 · No deposit fees

PROCESSING STATE

Confirming your deposit — typically under 5 seconds.

SUCCESS STATE

₦10,000 added. Today's markets are ready when you are.

FAILED PAYMENT ERROR

This payment didn't go through. Your card wasn't charged. Try another method, or check with your bank.

 **Writer's note:** Leading with “your card wasn't charged” removes the user's primary anxiety in the first sentence — the most important information goes first.

Withdrawal Flow

PAGE HEADING

Withdraw Your Winnings

PROCESSING TIME INFO

Most withdrawals arrive within 24 hours. Bank transfers may take 1–3 business days.

PENDING STATE

Your withdrawal is processing. We'll let you know the moment it's sent.

KYC PROMPT (VERIFICATION REQUIRED)

One step before we send your funds. We verify identity to protect your account — it takes about a minute.

 **Writer's note:** Framing identity verification as protection for the user, not a hurdle imposed by the platform, increases completion and reduces frustration.

Before / After Rewrite

BEFORE

Error: Transaction failed. Please check your payment details and try again. If the problem persists, contact customer support.

AFTER

This payment didn't go through. Your card wasn't charged. Try another method, or check with your bank.

05 · PUSH NOTIFICATIONS & ALERTS

Touchpoint: Push notifications — copy that must earn its place on a lock screen. Too generic and it's ignored; too pushy and it's switched off entirely.

Push Notifications

In-App Alerts

Re-Engagement

Responsible Gambling

Engagement Notifications

MATCH ALERT

Kickoff in 30 minutes: Arsenal vs. Chelsea. Markets are live now.

 **Writer's note:** Factual and time-specific rather than hype-driven (“Don't miss out!!”) — informative urgency fits the strategist tone better than emotional urgency.

BONUS REMINDER (USER HASN'T CLAIMED)

Your matched stake offer expires in 24 hours. Worth a look before kickoff.

 **Writer's note:** “Worth a look” is a soft, advisory nudge rather than a command — consistent with treating the user as someone making their own informed call.

WINNING STREAK ALERT

Three correct calls in a row, [Name]. Your form's looking sharp.

 **Writer's note:** “Form” is sports/betting terminology used deliberately — it reinforces the brand's premium, in-the-know voice rather than generic excitement language.

Account & Transaction Alerts

SUCCESSFUL DEPOSIT

£10,000 has landed in your account.

WITHDRAWAL PROCESSED

£25,000 is on its way to your account. Expected within 24 hours.

LOGIN FROM NEW DEVICE

New login detected. If this was you, no action needed. If not, secure your account now.

Responsible Gambling Notifications

SESSION TIME REMINDER

You've been active for 2 hours. A short break can sharpen your next call. We'll be here when you're back.

🔗 **Writer's note:** “Sharpen your next call” frames the break as a strategic advantage, not a restriction — language fully consistent with the brand's strategist identity.

DEPOSIT LIMIT REACHED

You've reached the weekly deposit limit you set. That's good discipline. Your limit resets Monday.

🔗 **Writer's note:** Calling the user's own limit “good discipline” affirms their judgement in language that matches a strategist brand, rather than treating it as a restriction imposed on them.

SELF-EXCLUSION CONFIRMATION

Your self-exclusion is confirmed and your account is now paused. Free, confidential support is available at GamCare.org.uk. We'll be here if you choose to return.

🔗 **Writer's note:** Self-exclusion copy is handled with care — no persuasion, no retention tactics, no guilt. Just clarity, a resource, and a calm, open door.

Before / After Rewrite

BEFORE

Don't forget! You have a bonus waiting. Log in now to claim your bonus before it expires.

AFTER

Your matched stake offer expires in 24 hours. Worth a look before kickoff.

A NOTE ON APPROACH

Good UX writing is invisible. When copy is working, users don't notice it — they just move through the experience feeling confident, informed, and in control. Every word in this case study was chosen to serve a specific function: reduce friction, build trust, reflect the brand, or move the user forward.

As a linguist, I approach UX writing through the lens of how language actually works — how structure, tone, and word choice shape perception and behaviour. That academic foundation, combined with hands-on content creation and communication experience, is what I bring to every piece of copy I write.

I am available for remote engagement immediately and would welcome the opportunity to bring this approach to your brand.